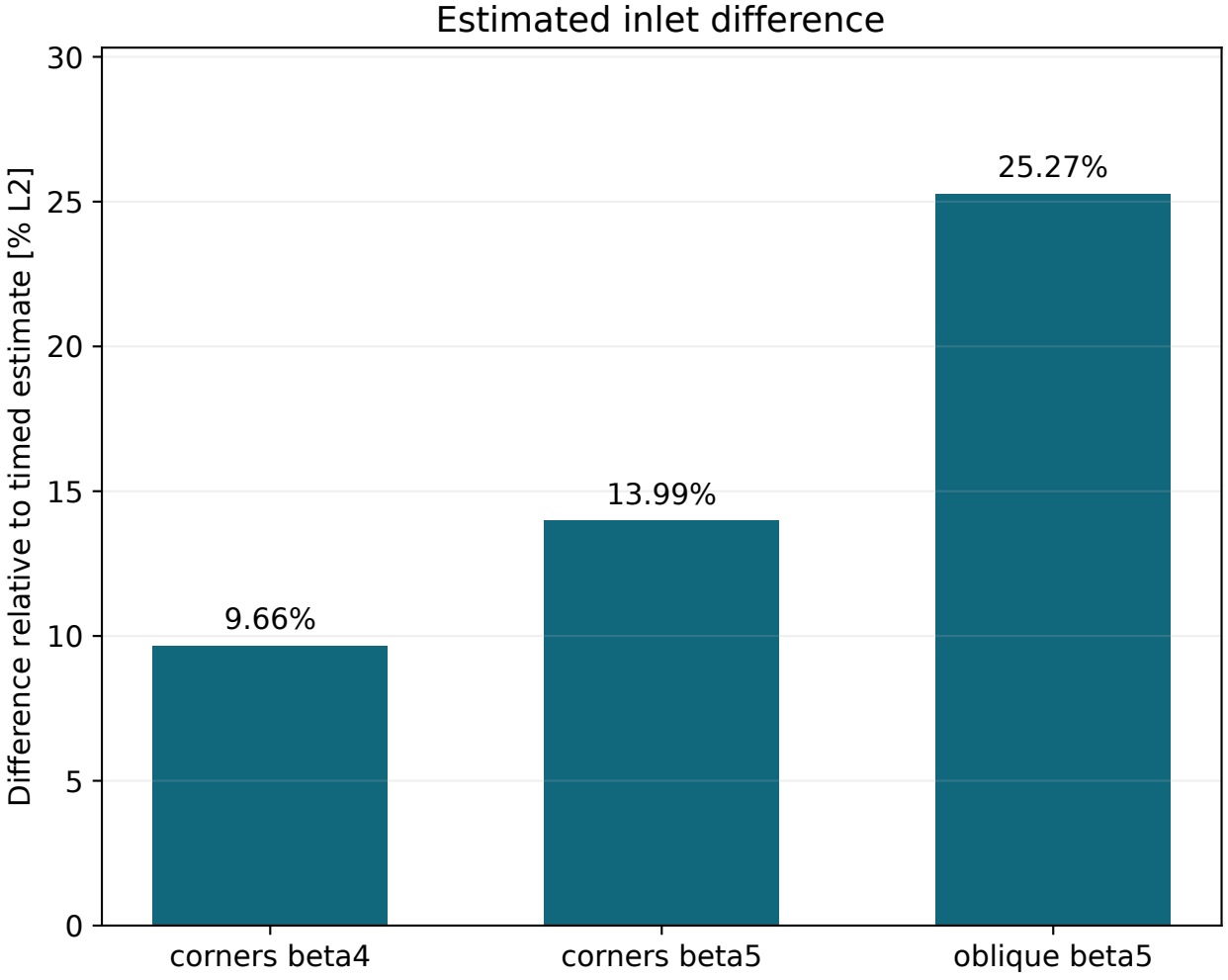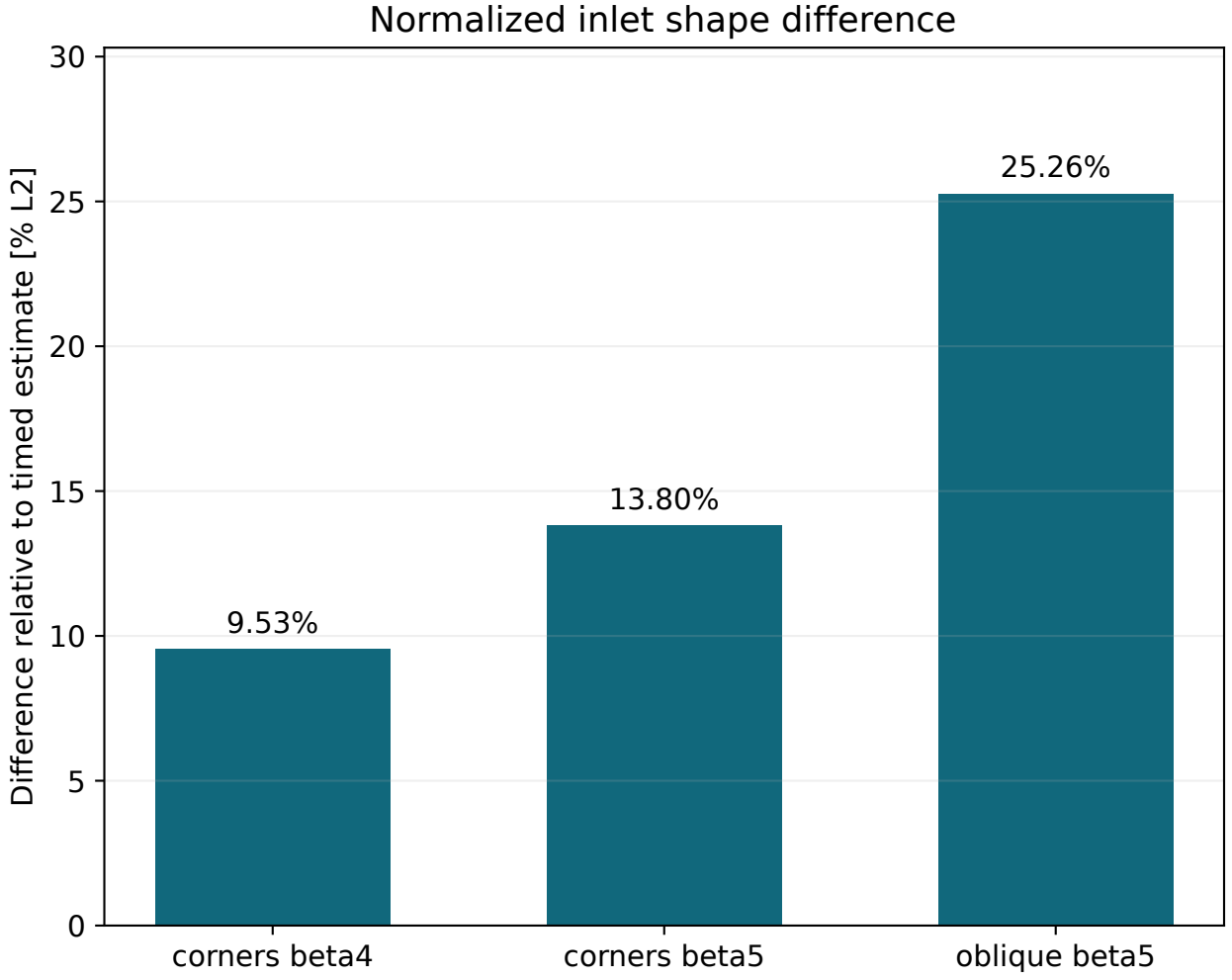Similar paths need not imply identical inlet profiles